

Fake or Masterpiece? Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • The Arts • 25-35 min

Category	The Arts	Time	25-35 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	fake-or-masterpiece

Big idea: Reputation affects judgement.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students test how reputation, authorship and context shape aesthetic judgement.

Student Prompt

Inspect Fake or Masterpiece? Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Fake or Masterpiece? Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Two artworks with different provenance stories but similar visual quality. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Fake or Masterpiece? Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: A value ranking before and after learning authorship. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Fake or Masterpiece? Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A debrief on whether knowledge about origin changes aesthetic knowledge. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Reputation affects judgement.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Fake or Masterpiece? Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Fake or Masterpiece? Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	Is artistic value in the object, the viewer or the culture?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to The Arts.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how reputation affects judgement.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: Is artistic value in the object, the viewer or the culture?

Setup Checklist

- Prepare a starter stimulus using: Two artworks with different provenance stories but similar visual quality.
- Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.
- Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Two artworks with different provenance stories but similar visual quality.
- A value ranking before and after learning authorship.
- A debrief on whether knowledge about origin changes aesthetic knowledge.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/fake-or-masterpiece/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/fake-or-masterpiece/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/fake-or-masterpiece/visual-prompt.svg>
- Printable student worksheet with observation, inference, evidence, and confidence columns.
- Teacher notes with setup checklist, sample facilitation language, misconceptions, and assessment look-fors.
- Classroom run kit with prompt cards, example stimuli, and debrief moves.
- PowerPoint deck with a student-facing sequence for running the activity.

Run Sequence

1. Students rank artworks by artistic value without context.
2. Reveal partial context: artist, date, price, AI-generated or not, museum status.
3. Students revise rankings and explain why.
4. Discuss whether context is part of the artwork.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: Is artistic value in the object, the viewer or the culture?

- Does knowing the artist change the artwork?
- Can AI produce art, or only images?

Teacher Quick Script

- Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.
- Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.
- What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...